

Remember: *The slides support your speech; you don't support the slides.*

Let's drill it in. If you will only (or mostly) read what's on screen, why are you there? Even looked at the other way, if you will only read what's on screen, why the PowerPoint presentation at all—you could just keep some speaker's notes with you! Either way, there must be a difference between—and at the same time, a concordance with—what's on the screen and what you say. A wise man once said: use PowerPoint, but the power lies not in the pointing.

You see, it's a stage act. PowerPoint, with all its options, lulls one into believing that the slides will do the job for you.

It's also a fine balancing act, this thing about how much to put on the slides and how much to say out aloud. Remember that aspect while preparing your slides as well.

2.3.2 Look

Tenet #2 is close behind #1. We want to emphasise the importance of eye contact. Never turn your back to the audience.

Be a performer. Ask questions. Elicit questions. Answer them. Discuss them. Gesticulate... When someone asks a question, look at that person and pay attention. Indicate with your eyes that you're paying attention. Then repeat the question for all to hear, and answer it. Point to the slide if you need to, *without* turning your back to those who have dedicated time to your presentation.

You can figure all this, actually, by attending a poor show. The presenter looks at the monitor or the screen much or most of the time. He does not *perform*. He does not care whether you're in the room or not.

Eye contact involves the audience, and that is of the essence. It's an act of disseminating information, so those who imbibe it should be as involved as the one professing it. Profess your knowledge. Do not dish it out.